

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Al Baster

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Al Baster

Sculptor & Public-Art Star

Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane.

- **Frank Lloyd Wrong** designed the entrance around Al's sculpture. They still disagree about which one visitors came to see.
- Competes with **Vincent Van Faux** for commissions. Al keeps calculating how many paintings weigh as much as one sculpture.
- **Dada DiCapo** once performed inside one of Al's sculptures. Al found out from the photographs.

ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Al Baster. I made the entrance sculpture. I would appreciate your admiration in a tone that suggests prompt payment.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Al Baster

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

Your other secret

You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline.

Conversations to start

- Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong whether the entrance display still includes your original sculpture.
- Ask Vincent Van Faux how he handles patrons who try to replace an artist's work.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1** *Find the frame that always contains a portrait of you; check its top.*
- 2** *A wall-hung painting has a backstage area. That is where to investigate.*
- 3** *A blue cushion has been acting as a very quiet accomplice. Check its reverse.*



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I changed the sculpture's support and left the fabricator's contribution out of the credit. Grant had ordered a cheaper replacement and disputed my balance. The original was standing at the entrance while the crew prepared to replace it. I had failed the people who built it with me. Seeing their work treated as something to discard made that failure harder to excuse.

IF MURDERER

I changed the sculpture's support and left the fabricator's contribution out of the credit. Grant had ordered a cheaper replacement and disputed my balance. The original was standing at the entrance while the crew prepared to replace it. I had failed the people who built it with me, and I was watching him turn months of our work into an opening-night prop.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I removed the decorative panel concealing the sculpture's internal support. The fabricator's joint was underneath it, beside my signature on the finished work. Grant had threatened to replace the sculpture and refuse the balance. I wanted the crew to see what had actually been made before he called it defective. I had failed to credit the fabricator myself. The open panel made that omission visible as well as the support.

IF MURDERER

I removed the decorative panel concealing the sculpture's internal support. The fabricator's joint was underneath it, beside my signature on the finished work. Grant had threatened to replace the sculpture and refuse the balance. I wanted the crew to see what had actually been made before he called it defective. I had failed to credit the fabricator myself. The open panel made that omission visible as well as the support.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Al Baster

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Al Baster

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The fabricator's name is on the drawing I retained. The plaster on my hands came from opening the sculpture's temporary support for the crew. Their installation photographs show the replacement Grant had ordered and my original beside it. I had concealed a departure from the approved plan. I was trying to correct that record before he used the photographs to call my sculpture a replica of his replacement.

IF MURDERER

After opening the support panel, I kept my work apron on. Grant was still talking about replacing the sculpture as though the people who made it had never existed. In the salon I lifted his empty glass and offered a toast to the fabricator whose name I had left off the work. I put it back. I had not suddenly become generous about credit; I wanted him embarrassed before he embarrassed me. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap in my apron pocket. I wore that apron on the preparation walkthrough too. The drawing identifies the worker I should have credited from the beginning.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Al Baster

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Al Baster

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I changed the support from the approved plan and omitted the fabricator's credit. The drawing and shop photographs establish both. I did not poison Grant. I will correct the construction record, credit the workers and settle their invoices before disputing my own balance. His proposed replica does not erase my original obligations.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough and poisoned Grant's uncovered glass in the salon. The mock toast gave me a reason to lift it. A fragment of the bottle's custody band remained in my work-apron pocket; another was found inside the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison linked the material, and I had admitted wearing the apron at both places. He intended to replace my sculpture and refuse the balance. I killed him over the contract and pretended I was defending the people whose credit I had withheld.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.
